



Axel the Axolotl

An amigurumi crochet pattern

US terms

Advanced beginner

2.5 - 3 hours

11.5 cm / 4.5 in tall

*A soft pink axolotl with six fluffy gills, a round head and a shell-edged paddle tail.
Head, neck, body and tail are worked as one continuous spiral - no neck seam to sew.*

36

stitches around
head and body

52

rounds, all
count-checked

6

fluffy gills,
3 per side

5

dc scallops
on the tail fin

Welcome

A soft pink axolotl with six fluffy gills, a round head and a shell-edged paddle tail. Head, neck, body and tail are worked as one continuous spiral - no neck seam to sew.

11.5 cm

TALL, SEATED

10 cm

GILL TIP TO TIP

4.3 cm

TAIL

52 mm

HEAD SPHERE

In this booklet

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Axel sits about 11.5 cm tall - a true palm-sized plushie.

SAFETY - READ THIS FIRST

Axel has two 6 mm safety eyes. Safety eyes are small parts: lock the washers firmly from the inside before stuffing, and pull-test every eye on the finished toy - a properly locked washer will not come off by hand. The gills, arms, feet and tail fin are all sewn or worked on: sew each seam twice and weave every end in for at least 5 cm, then trim close - a loose gill is the first thing a child will pull. This pattern has not been tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71, so do not describe finished Axels as "baby-safe". For children under 3, skip the safety eyes and stitch the eyes with black floss instead.

1 · Materials

Main yarn	Worsted #4, pale pink, about 15 g. Cotton or acrylic with a smooth matte finish - one 25 g ball covers the whole axolotl.
Gill yarn	Fuzzy / eyelash / fur yarn, dark pink, about 8 g. Essential: smooth worsted will not give fluffy gills, and the gills are the whole look.
Fin yarn	Worsted #4, dark pink, about 3 g, smooth - so the shell edging stays crisp.
Hook & eyes	3.5 mm (US E/4) for a tight gauge so stuffing cannot show through. Two 6 mm safety eyes (9 mm reads as buggy on this head).
Also	Polyester filling about 8 g; tapestry needle; black embroidery floss; pink pastel or chalk; stitch marker.



Everything you need - one 25 g ball of pale pink covers the whole toy.

GAUGE

36 sc around measures about 52 mm across when stuffed (4.5 mm per stitch, 4.3 mm per round). Wider than 55 mm? Drop to a 3.0 mm hook; under 48 mm? Go up to 4.0 mm.

Abbreviations (US terms)

MR magic ring	ch chain
sc single crochet	dc double crochet
inc increase (2 sc in one st)	invdec invisible decrease
sl st slip stitch	st(s) stitch(es)
FO fasten off	(n) stitch count at round end

2 · Five techniques

These are the five techniques Axel uses, in the order you will meet them.

1

The magic ring

Every piece begins with a magic ring. Wrap the yarn once around two fingers, insert the hook, pull up a loop and work your first round into the ring, then pull the tail to close it tight once the first round is complete.

2

Work in a spiral

Do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds - just keep going round after round. Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and move it up each time; there is no join to count from.

3

The invisible decrease

Insert the hook through the front loops only of the next two stitches, yarn over and pull through both, then yarn over and pull through the remaining two loops. It leaves no ridge, which matters on the head and neck where decreases are visible.

4

Closing through both layers

To close a flat opening, fold the piece flat so the front and back layers lie together, then work one sc through each matched pair of stitches. Axel's 6-stitch tail tip folds into 3 pairs and closes with 3 sc.

5

The shell (scallop)

Work all the stitches of the group into one stitch, then slip stitch into the next stitch to anchor it. The group fans into a cup. Working the dc loosely makes each scallop cup outward instead of lying flat.



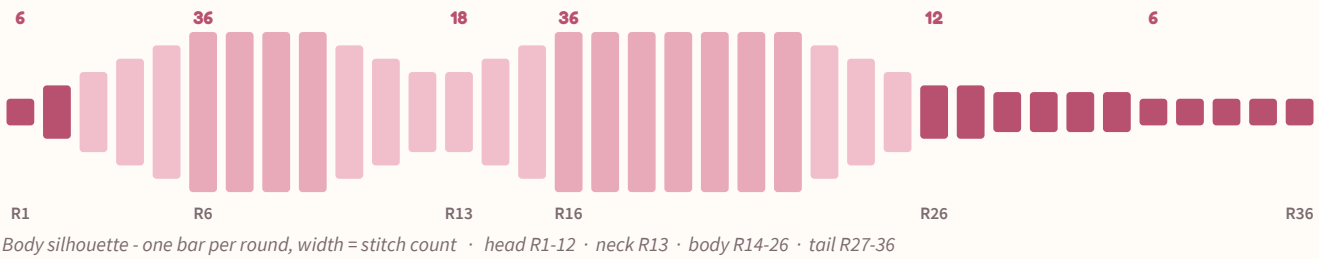
Working in a spiral

Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and move it up each time. There is no join to count from, so the marker is your only landmark - and the reason Axel's head has no seam.

Tip: the invisible decrease is worth practising on a scrap first. Every decrease on the head and neck is visible on the finished toy.

3 · Body – one spiral, head to tail

Worked in a single spiral from the top of the head straight through to the tail tip. Head and body are both 36 stitches around; the neck at R13 is the only waist. Three straight rounds at the head keep it spherical rather than egg-shaped.



Head & neck · R1 - R13

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	start at top of head
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[1 sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	
R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	head at full width
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	eyes between R7 / R8
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	
R9	sc in each st around	(36)	smile on R8 - R9
R10	[4 sc, invdec] x 6	(30)	
R11	[3 sc, invdec] x 6	(24)	STUFF HEAD FIRMLY
R12	[2 sc, invdec] x 6	(18)	
R13	sc in each st around	(18)	NECK - narrowest point

BEFORE YOU LEAVE THE HEAD

Insert the safety eyes between R7 and R8 (6 stitches apart), embroider the smile across R8-R9, then stuff the head **firmlly** at R11 - it must hold a sphere so the eyes stay level. See Assembly for exact placement.

Body · R14 - R26

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R14	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	body flares out
R15	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	
R16	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	body at full width
R17	sc in each st around	(36)	arms at R17 - R18
R18	sc in each st around	(36)	
R19	sc in each st around	(36)	
R20	sc in each st around	(36)	
R21	sc in each st around	(36)	
R22	sc in each st around	(36)	
R23	[4 sc, invdec] x 6	(30)	
R24	[3 sc, invdec] x 6	(24)	FEET attach at R24 - R25
R25	[2 sc, invdec] x 6	(18)	stuff body LIGHTLY
R26	[1 sc, invdec] x 6	(12)	

Tail · R27 - R36

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R27	sc in each st around	(12)	tail begins
R28	[2 sc, invdec] x 3	(9)	
R29	sc in each st around	(9)	
R30	sc in each st around	(9)	
R31	sc in each st around	(9)	
R32	[1 sc, invdec] x 3	(6)	light stuffing to here
R33	sc in each st around	(6)	
R34	sc in each st around	(6)	
R35	sc in each st around	(6)	
R36	sc in each st around	(6)	taper to tip

FINISH THE TAIL TIP

Fold the last 6 stitches flat so 3 pairs line up (3 front + 3 back), then work 1 sc through each pair - 3 sc in total - to close the tip cleanly. FO and weave the end back through the tail tip and out along the top ridge; you will crochet the fin directly onto that ridge. The tail runs R27-R36 - ten rounds, about 43 mm - giving the fin a long enough ridge to sit on.

4 · Arms & feet

Arms and feet are sewn on, not worked into the body - bobbles will not give you rounded limbs.

Arms - make 2

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	sc around	(6)	
R3	sc around	(6)	
R4	sc around	(6)	
R5	sc around	(6)	
R6	sc around, then FO	(6)	arms finish here

FO with a long tail, do not stuff. Flatten the open end and sew it closed as you attach, so the arms hang softly.

Feet - make 2

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	[1 sc, inc] x 3	(9)	
R3	sc around	(9)	
R4	sc around	(9)	
R5	[1 sc, invdec] x 3	(6)	feet finish here

FO, cinch closed with a long tail and stuff lightly - do not flatten them, they are plump little balls; sew the cinched nub toward the body.

5 · Gills - make 6 (3 per side, fuzzy dark pink)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	sc around	(12)	
R4	sc around	(12)	
R5	[1 sc, invdec] x 4	(8)	open edge sewn to head

WORKING WITH FUZZY YARN

You cannot see the stitches. Hold a thin strand of matching smooth yarn together with the fur yarn so you can find the stitches, or count by feel with the hook tip and trust the round count. Small errors are invisible in the finished fluff.

FO with a long tail. The open edge sewn straight to the head disappears in the fluff - simply whip-stitch the 8-st opening flat against the head (or cinch the front loops first if you prefer a rounded lobe). Three fluffy gills fan behind each eye - upper angled up, middle out, lower down.



Three lobes fan behind each eye: upper up, middle out, lower down.

6 · Tail fin - shell edging

Five loose double-crochet scallops form the shell-edged paddle along the tail ridge.

With smooth dark pink yarn, join with a sl st to the top ridge of the tail at the very tip (join into the tip end-closure corner). Working along the ridge back toward the body:

SCALLOP REPEAT

* 5 dc in the next ridge stitch, sl st in the next ridge stitch.
Repeat from * a total of **5 times** (5 scallops). FO and weave in.

Each scallop uses 2 ridge stitches, so the fin spans 10 stitches. The tail from R27 to R36 gives a ridge of about 10 workable stitches along one side, so 5 scallops fit it exactly - start at the tip and work back toward the body, then anchor the last sl st into the body junction. Work the dc groups loosely so each scallop cups outward. For a fuller paddle, work a second identical 5-scallop row along the underside ridge rather than stretching one row around the tip.



Each scallop uses 2 ridge stitches - 5 scallops fit the 10-round tail exactly.

A NOTE ON FULLNESS

Five shells over ten rounds is meant to ruffle - the cupped, frilly edge is the look, not a mistake. If the scallops seem crowded, work the dc even more loosely, use half a hook size larger for the fin yarn only, or work 4 scallops on a shorter ridge.

7 · Assembly

BEFORE YOU SEW - LAY EVERY COMPONENT OUT AND CHECK

1 body · 2 arms · 2 feet · 6 gills · 1 fin - check each against the pattern before attaching anything.

Eyes

Insert the 6 mm safety eyes between R7 and R8, 6 stitches apart, centred on the front of the head. Six stitches spans about 27 mm on the 52 mm head - about half the width. Fix the washers before stuffing, and pull-test each eye once it is locked.

Smile

With black floss, embroider a wide shallow U across R8-R9, centred between the eyes and about 5 stitches wide. Keep it shallow; a deep curve reads as a frown.

Blush

Brush soft pink pastel or chalk in a small circle directly under each eye, just outside the eye line.

Gills

Sew 3 lobes to each side of the head, behind the eyes, anchored at about R6 (upper), R7-R8 (middle) and R9 (lower). Angle the top lobe upward, the middle one straight out and the bottom one downward so they fan, then tease the fibres apart with a slicker brush or your fingers.

Arms

Sew one arm to each side at R17-R18, about 6 stitches out from the centre front, angled slightly forward.

Feet

Sew one foot to each side of the centre front at R24-R25, about 4 stitches out from centre, so Axel sits flat and upright.



8 · Troubleshooting

Head firm, body soft. Stuff the head hard at R11 so it holds a sphere and the eyes stay level. Keep the body light so Axel stays squishy and sits down.

Neck collapsing. The 18-stitch neck is deliberately narrow. First pack a little more stuffing into the neck through the body opening before closing R25. For a permanently sturdier neck, work R13 as [7 sc, inc] x 2, 2 sc (20), then change R14 to [4 sc, inc] x 4 (24) so it consumes all 20 stitches; R15 onward is unchanged.

Fin runs out of tail. The ridge holds 10 stitches and 5 scallops need exactly 10. If you shortened the tail, work fewer scallops rather than crowding them.

Want a wider gill span? As written the gills give about 10 cm tip to tip. Work each gill two rounds longer - add 2 plain rounds at 12 stitches before R5 - for a span of about 12 cm.

Stuffing shows through. Go down to a 3.0 mm hook. Loose gauge on a 3.5 mm hook is the usual cause.

Axel will not sit. Move the feet one round lower and make sure the R23-R26 decreases are centred on the underside, not the back.

Colourways



Classic pink



White leucistic



Melanoid black



Mint



Lavender



Left to right: classic pink, white leucistic, melanoid black, mint, lavender. Swap the main and gill yarns - the pattern is unchanged.

9 · Terms of use

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